

The Executive Energy System

Quick Reference Guide

Print this page and keep it at your desk for daily reference

Daily Energy Optimization Checklist

Morning Routine (60 min)

- ☐ Wake at consistent time (± 15 min)
- ☐ Check HRV (1 min) - Track trend
- ☐ Sunlight exposure (10-30 min) - No sunglasses
- ☐ Wim Hof breathing (10 min) - 3 rounds
- ☐ Cold shower (2-3 min) - Build resilience
- ☐ High-protein breakfast (30-40g) - Within 90 min of waking
- ☐ Review Three-Horizon goals (5 min)
- ☐ **START 90-min Flow Block** - Peak cognitive work

Midday Protocol (30 min)

- ☐ Protein-rich lunch - Lower carbs to avoid crash
- ☐ 10-min walk - Preferably outside
- ☐ Box breathing if stressed (2 min) - 4-4-4-4 pattern

Afternoon Energy Management (2-4pm)

- ☐ **Energy dip is normal** - Circadian rhythm
- ☐ Choose ONE:
 - 20-min power nap (set alarm)
 - 10-min brisk walk (outside if possible)
 - Low-stakes tasks (email, admin)

Evening Routine (90 min)

- ☐ Dinner with complex carbs - Supports sleep

- ☐ Screen cutoff (90 min before bed) - Blue light kills melatonin
 - ☐ Sauna or hot bath (20 min) - 3-4x/week
 - ☐ Journaling (10 min) - Process stress
 - ☐ Coherent breathing (10 min) - 5 sec in, 5 sec out
 - ☐ Magnesium supplement (400mg) - Optional
 - ☐ Bed at consistent time (± 15 min)
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The 10 Core Frameworks

1. Three-Horizon Performance Model

- **Horizon 1:** Present performance (today-3 months)
- **Horizon 2:** Future capacity (1-3 years)
- **Horizon 3:** Long-term legacy (20+ years)
- **Action:** Optimize all three simultaneously

2. S.L.E.E.P. Protocol

- **Strategic Schedule** - Same time daily
- **Light Management** - Sun AM, darkness PM
- **Engineered Environment** - Cool, dark, quiet
- **Evening Routine** - 60-min wind-down
- **Performance Nutrition** - No caffeine after 2pm

3. Metabolic Flexibility Matrix

- **Protein:** 0.7-1g per lb body weight
- **Fats:** 20-30% of calories (healthy sources)
- **Carbs:** Strategic timing (moderate AM, low midday, higher PM)
- **Fasting:** 12-hour eating window minimum

4. Stress Inoculation Protocol

- **Measure:** HRV daily (higher = better recovery)
- **Breathe:** Box breathing before/during stress
- **Expose:** Voluntary stress (cold, HIIT, fasting)
- **Recover:** 24-48 hours after high stress

5. Energy Portfolio Model

- **Cognitive Energy:** Peak 0-4 hours after waking
- **Physical Energy:** Dip at 2-3pm (normal)
- **Emotional Energy:** Depleted by conflict/decisions
- **Action:** Match tasks to energy levels

6. Recovery Triad

- **Cold:** 2-3 min daily (shower or ice bath)
- **Heat:** 20 min sauna 3-4x/week
- **Compression:** Legs-up-wall 10 min daily

7. Flow Activation Protocol

- **Challenge:** 4% above current skill level
- **Goals:** Specific, clear targets
- **Feedback:** Immediate, real-time
- **Focus:** 90+ min uninterrupted
- **Result:** 500% productivity boost

8. Antifragility Protocol

- **Physical:** Hormetic stress (cold, HIIT, fasting)
- **Mental:** Progressive exposure to discomfort
- **Emotional:** Daily journaling, reframing
- **Social:** Build support network
- **Purpose:** Connect challenges to meaning

9. Three Breathwork Protocols

- **Box Breathing:** 4-4-4-4 (calm/focus)
- **Wim Hof:** 30 breaths + hold (energy/clarity)
- **Coherent:** 5-5 pattern (HRV optimization)

10. Quantified Wellness System

- **Measure:** HRV, sleep, energy daily
 - **Analyze:** Find patterns weekly
 - **Experiment:** Test one variable (7 days)
 - **Integrate:** Keep what works (>5% improvement)
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Emergency Protocols

When Stress Hits

- 1 Box Breathing (2 min) - 4-4-4-4 pattern
- 2 10-min walk - Get outside
- 3 Identify trigger - What caused this?
- 4 Reframe - "This builds resilience"

When Energy Crashes

- 5 Check HRV - Low = rest day
- 6 20-min power nap - Set alarm
- 7 Protein + water - Fuel up
- 8 Reduce cognitive load - Easy tasks only

When Sleep is Poor

- 9 Morning sun (30 min) - Reset circadian rhythm
- 10 No caffeine today - Already stressed
- 11 Light exercise only - No HIIT
- 12 Early bedtime tonight - Catch up

When Decision Quality Drops

- 13 Stop making decisions - Defer if possible
- 14 Eat protein - Glucose for brain
- 15 5-min box breathing - Restore prefrontal cortex
- 16 Consult trusted advisor - Get perspective

Weekly Tracking

Every Sunday (15 min Review)

HRV Trend:

- This week avg: _____ ms
- Last week avg: _____ ms
- Trend: ↑ ↓ →

Sleep Quality:

- Avg hours: _____
- Avg deep sleep: _____
- Nights on schedule: ____/7

Energy Levels (1-10):

- Morning: _____
- Midday: _____
- Evening: _____

Compliance:

- Morning routine: ____/7
- Evening routine: ____/7
- Flow blocks: ____/7
- Recovery protocols: ____/7

This Week's Experiment:

- Variable tested: _____
- Result: _____
- Keep or discard: _____

Next Week's Focus:

- Priority 1: _____
- Priority 2: _____
- Priority 3: _____

Key Metrics to Track

Metric	Target	Why It Matters
HRV	Increasing trend	#1 recovery indicator
Sleep Duration	7-8 hours	Cognitive performance
Deep Sleep	1.5-2 hours	Physical recovery

Metric	Target	Why It Matters
REM Sleep	1.5-2 hours	Mental processing
Resting Heart Rate	Decreasing	Cardiovascular fitness
Deep Work Hours	10+ per week	High-value output
Protein Intake	0.7-1g per lb	Muscle/brain fuel
Caffeine Cutoff	Before 2pm	Sleep quality

Monthly Experiments to Try

Month 1:

- ☐ Magnesium glycinate before bed (400mg)
- ☐ No alcohol for 30 days
- ☐ 12-hour eating window

Month 2:

- ☐ Cold exposure daily (2-3 min)
- ☐ Sauna 4x/week (20 min)
- ☐ No caffeine after 12pm

Month 3:

- ☐ 16-hour fasting window
- ☐ Morning sunlight within 30 min of waking
- ☐ Evening coherent breathing (10 min)

Track each experiment for 7 days, keep what improves HRV/sleep/energy by >5%

Red Flags (When to Rest)

- ☐ HRV drops >10% below baseline
- ☐ Resting heart rate increases >5 bpm
- ☐ Sleep quality poor 2+ nights in a row
- ☐ Energy levels <5/10 for 3+ days
- ☐ Getting sick (sore throat, fatigue)

Action: Take a rest day. No intense exercise, extra sleep, reduce stress.

Resources

Tracking Devices:

- Oura Ring (\$299-\$399) - Best for sleep/HRV
- WHOOP Strap (\$239/year) - Best for athletes
- Apple Watch (\$399+) - All-in-one solution

Apps:

- HRV tracking: Elite HRV, HRV4Training
- Breathwork: Breathe+, Wim Hof Method
- Sleep: Sleep Cycle, AutoSleep
- Meditation: Headspace, Calm

Books:

- "Why We Sleep" - Matthew Walker
 - "The Oxygen Advantage" - Patrick McKeown
 - "Peak Performance" - Brad Stulberg
 - "The 4-Hour Body" - Tim Ferriss
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Your Personal Stack (Build Over 12 Weeks)

Morning:

Midday:

Evening:

Weekly:

Remember: Sustainable peak performance is a marathon, not a sprint. Build your stack one protocol at a time.

Million Dollar Blueprint - The Executive Energy System